# PROJECT REPORT

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# INTRODUCTION

The Digital Literacy project is intended to be a comprehensive training program for my role as a Student Digital Ambassador at VIT Bhopal. In an era where academic and professional success is inextricably tied to one's digital literacy skills, this project is a comprehensive exploration of the essential pillars of modern computing.

The scenario is designed to be a stepwise progression from basic Python coding skills to develop technical problem-solving skills, cloud-based collaboration through Google Forms, and finally mastering professional etiquette through email etiquette. The last two modules are a critical exploration of cybersecurity and how to identify and prevent some of the most prevalent cybersecurity attacks like UPI fraud and phishing in India. By completing these five tasks, I have developed a comprehensive skillset that not only encompasses technical coding skills and cybersecurity but also professional networking skills that will be essential in a tech-driven world in 2026.

# Task - 1 : Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

## Visual Representation of Digital Literacy:

To meet the project's requirement for "visual communication," I used Canva to make a detailed infographic about "Digital Literacy for Students." I chose Canva for this task because it has a lot of different design elements and layouts that helped me turn complicated technical ideas into a format that was both visually appealing and easy for students to understand.

## What the Design Shows:

The infographic is divided into five parts, which correspond to the main sections of this project. It begins with a definition of Digital Literacy and then proceeds to a list of Essential Tools, including Notion and Google Workspace. The main parts discuss how to stay safe on the internet, such as using two-factor authentication (2FA) and setting privacy settings, as well as how to establish a professional online presence. Lastly, it includes a useful Email Etiquette guide that outlines what you should and shouldn't do when communicating for school or work.

## The Interesting/Difficult Part:

The hardest part of the design process for me was "Information Hierarchy." It was interesting to learn how to use visual cues, like neon icons and colour-coded blocks, to help a reader find the most important safety tips without giving them too much text.Balancing aesthetic appeal with the strict requirement for 10 distinct, actionable tips taught me that effective digital communication is as much about design as it is about content.

# Task - 2 : Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

### My Digital Roadmap for the Next Four Years:

For this project, I've chosen five platforms that I believe are essential for any AIML student: GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle, Stack Overflow, and ResearchGate. Each one plays a unique role in how I'll build my career. GitHub is where I'll store all my "proof of work" and coding projects, while LinkedIn is my bridge to the professional world. I'm especially excited about Kaggle for its hands-on data challenges, Stack Overflow for when I inevitably run into those tricky coding bugs, and ResearchGate to keep an eye on the latest breakthroughs in Artificial Intelligence.

## My Four-Year Plan:

As I start my journey at VIT Bhopal, I don't just want these to be empty profiles. I plan to use GitHub as a daily diary of my progress, showing recruiters that I'm consistent. On Kaggle, I've set a goal to enter at least two competitions every semester to push my machine learning skills beyond the classroom. I'll use LinkedIn to find mentors and land internships, while slowly becoming a contributor on Stack Overflow to help others as I learn. By the time I reach my final year, I expect ResearchGate to be my primary resource for my capstone project, helping me stay at the cutting edge of tech.

# Task - 3 : Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

### My Tech Toolkit: From Coding to Collaboration

For the third part of this project, I dove into three platforms that I know will be my "best friends" throughout my CSE journey: CodeChef, HackerEarth, and Google Forms. While CodeChef and HackerEarth gave me a place to really test my coding grit, Google Forms taught me the more practical side of things—how to actually collect and manage data from other people.

## What I Actually Did:

On CodeChef and HackerEarth, I spent time tackling basic Python challenges. I focused a lot on loops and logic by building things like the star pattern project. It was a great reality check—it taught me that writing code that "just works" isn't enough; it also needs to be efficient. On the flip side, I used Google Forms to create a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz." I had to think through the user experience, set up an answer key, and link it all to a Google Sheet so I could see the data pop up instantly as people responded.

## How This Helps Me at VIT:

I see these tools as my foundation for the next four years at VIT Bhopal. CodeChef and HackerEarth are going to be my primary training grounds for competitive programming and future job interviews. Meanwhile, Google Forms is a skill I'll use constantly for club activities and research surveys. Getting comfortable with these now means I can focus on more complex AIML concepts later, knowing I've already mastered the essentials of clean code and data management.

# Task - 4 : Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

## The Real Cost of a "Lazy" Email:

We've all been there—stressed out, running late, and just wanting to send a quick message to get a deadline moved. But "texting" a professor can backfire hard. Imagine a student at VIT Bhopal sending a last-minute email that just says: *"Hey, can't finish the lab, need an extension. Thx."* Without a subject line or even a registration number, that email is almost guaranteed to get buried in a professor's inbox. In this scenario, the student ended up with a zero because the professor never even saw the request. What started as a simple oversight turned into a messy confrontation during office hours that seriously hurt the student's reputation.

## What should have happened instead?

A little bit of professional etiquette goes a long way. The student should have treated that email like a formal request: including their Registration Number in the subject line so it was easy to find, using a proper greeting, and actually explaining the situation politely. Most importantly, sending that request at least a day or two early shows you actually respect the professor's time. A professional approach usually gets you a "Yes," while a messy one almost always gets you a "No."

# Task - 5 : Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

## What I Learned: It’s Not Just "Hacking"

Going into this research, I honestly thought "cybercrime" was all about genius hackers typing millions of lines of code to break into a bank’s database. What really caught me off guard was finding out how much of it is actually just "social engineering"—basically, just clever psychological tricks. It was pretty scary to see how easily someone can lose their entire bank balance just by entering a UPI PIN on a screen they thought was for *receiving* a payment. Realizing that the weakest link in security isn't usually the software, but the person using it, was a massive wake-up call for me.

## My Big Habit Change:

Because of what I’ve learned, I’m officially done with using the same "easy-to-remember" password for everything. I always thought Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) was just an annoying extra step that wasted my time, but I’ve finally enabled it on my VIT student portal and my Gmail. I’ve also started using a password manager so I don’t have to compromise on security for the sake of convenience. It’s a small change, but I now see it as a non-negotiable shield for my academic and personal life.

# Conclusion

## My Digital Literacy Journey :

Looking back, this project has been a huge part of my first-year experience at VIT Bhopal. It’s been quite a ride—going from figuring out my first Python star patterns to really digging into how UPI scams work. It’s made me realize that being "digitally literate" is so much more than just knowing how to code or use an app. It’s about how I talk to professors, how I handle data with others, and how I keep myself safe in an increasingly messy online world.

As an AIML student, these aren't just "tasks" to me; they’re the real-world skills I’ll need for the rest of my career. This project really pushed me to stop just "using" tech and start actually understanding it as a responsible, secure, and professional digital citizen. I feel a lot more prepared now to take on the challenges of the next four years, knowing I’ve got the right foundations in place.

# References


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